(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1 and 3 only

Ans. (b) : Statement 1: Out of the 5723 assessment units assessed jointly by the state groundwater department and CGWA in the country, as per report of Niti Aayog the following is the Data- safe- 71%, semi critical- 10%, critical- 4% & our exibited- 15% Hence, the statement 1 is incorrect.

Statement 2: Central Ground Water Authority (GWA) constituted under Section 3(3) of 'The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986' regulates extraction of groundwater through guidelines that are updated regularly. Hence the statement is correct.

Statement 3: At 39 million hectares (60% of its total irrigation) India has the world's largest groundwater well-equipped irrigation system (China with 19 mha is second, USA with 17 mha is third).

87. If a particular plant species is placed under Schedule VI of The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, what is the implication?

(a) A licence is required to cultivate that plant.
(b) Such a plant cannot be cultivated under any circumstances.
(c) It is a Genetically Modified crop plant.
(d) Such a plant is invasive and harmful to the ecosystem

Ans. (a) : The specified endemic plants in Schedule VI of the wild life protection act, 1972 are prohibited from cultivation and planting. As such a licence is required to cultivate that plant. Hence, the correct statement is (a).

88. Among the following Tiger Reserves, which one has the largest area under "Critical Tiger Habitat"?

(a) Corbett
(b) Ranthambore
(c) Nagarjunsagar-Srisailam
(d) Sunderbans

Ans. (c) :

Tiger Reserve	Area of the core/Critical Tiger Habitat (sq.km.)
Corbett	821.99
Ranthambore	1113.364
Nagarjunsagar Srisailam	2595.72
Sunderbans	1699.62

Therefore, the correct answer is (c).

89. According to India's National Policy on Biofuels, which of the following can be used as raw materials for the production of biofuels?

1. Cassava
2. Damaged wheat grains
3. Groundnut seeds
4. Horse gram
5. Rotten potatoes
6. Sugar beet

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1,2, 5 and 6 only (b) 1, 3 4 and 6 only
(c) 2, 3 4 and 5 only (d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6

Ans. (a) : The National Policy on Biofuels expands the scope of raw materials for ethanol production by allowing the use of sugarcane juice, sugar containing materials like sugar beet, sweet sorghum, starch - containing materials like corn, cassava, damaged food grains like wheat, broken rice, rotten potatoes. Unfit for human consumption for ethanol production. Hence, the correct is (a).

90. Which one of the following statements best describes the term 'Social Cost of Carbon'?

It is a measure, in monetary value, of the

(a) long-term damage done by a tonne of CO_2 emissions in a given years.
(b) requirement of fossil fuels for a country to provide goods and services to its citizens, based on the burning of those fuels.
(c) efforts put in by a climate refugee to adapt to live in a new place.
(d) contribution of an individual person to the carbon footprint on the planet Earth.

Ans. (a) : The Social Cost of Carbon (SCC) is the marginal cost of the impacts caused by emitting one extra tonne of greenhouse gas (carbon dioxide equivalent) at any point in time, inclusive of non market impacts on the environment and human health. The purpose of putting a price on a ton of emitted CO_2 is to aid policy makers or other legislative in evaluating whether a policy designed to curb climate change is justified. Hence, option (a) is correct answer.

91. With reference to Indian elephants, consider the following statements:

1. The leader of an elephant group is a female
2. The maximum gestation period can be 22 months.
3. an elephant can normally go on calving till the age of 40 years only.
4. Among the States in India, the highest elephant population is in Kerala.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1,3 and 4 only

Ans. (a) : Statement 1: The leader of a group is the oldest female. She guides the herd in their search of food and water sources. These matriarchal units can occasionally divide into smaller, temporary groups. Hence, it is correct.

Statement 2: A breeding pair remains together for about 3 weeks. The gestation period lasts for 22 months, yielding a single baby. During the birth, females of the herd surround the mother in order to protect her. Hence, it is correct.

Statement 3: Adulthood starts at about 18 years of age and the elephant has an average life expectancy of 70 years. Although sexually mature in their early teens, elephants generally only start to mate at about 20 years and stop bearing calves at about 50. Hence, it is not correct.

Statement 4: South India had the highest number of wild elephants–14,612. Among the South Indian states, Karnataka leads the table with 6049 elephants, followed by Assam (5719) and Kerala (3054).

92. Which of the following Protected Areas are located in Cauvery basin?

1. Nagarhole National Park
2. Papikonda National Park
3. Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve
4. Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c) : All except (2) are part of the Cauvery basin. Papikonda remains entirely inside the East and West Godavari districts near the Godavari basin after 2014 and after the construction of Polavaram Dam.

93. With reference to India's biodiversity, Ceylon frogmouth, Coppersmith barbet, Gray-chinned minivet and white-throated redstart are

(a) Birds (b) Primates
(c) Reptiles (d) Amphibians

Ans. (a) : The Srilankan frogmouth or Ceylon frogmouth (Batrachostomus maniliger) is a small frogmouth found in the western ghats of South India and Sri Lanka. It is a bird that reaches 23 m (9.1 in) in length. The Coppersmith barbet, is a resident bird in the Indian Sub-continent and parts of South East Asia. The grey chinned minivet is found from the Himalayas to China, Taiwan and Southeast Asia. The white throated redstart is found in Nepal, Bhutan, Central China and far northern areas of Myanmar and North east India. Its natural habitat is temperate forest. Hence, option (a) is correct.

94. Which one of the following protected areas is well-known for the conservation of a sub-species of the Indian swamp deer (Barasingha) that thrives well on hard ground and is exclusively graminivorous?

(a) Kanha National Park
(b) Manas National Park
(c) Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary
(d) Tal Chhapar Wildlife Sanctuary

Ans. (a) : The revival of Barasingha, (It listed in appendix I of CITES and schedule I of wildlife protection Act of 1972) an endangered and endemic cervidae, belonging to the cervidae family, in the Kanha Tiger Reserve is hailed as one of the most successful and inspiring conservation projects in the world. While Kanha's name may be synonymous with the tiger, it is actually the hard ground barasingha that has consistently challenged the professionalism, including foresightedness and managerial adaptability of the Kanha management. Hence, the correct is (a).

95. Which of the following are the most likely places to find the musk deer in its natural habitat?

1. Askot Wildlife Sanctuary
2. Gangotri National Park
3. Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary
4. Manas National Park

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1 and 4 only

Ans. (a) : Musk deer is a small compact deer belonging to the family Cervidae. A solitary shy animal, the musk deer, lives in mountainous regions from Siberia to the Himalayas.

Askot Musk Deer Sanctuary is located 54 km from Pithoragarh near the town of Askot in Uttarakhand. As the name suggests, the sanctuary has been set up primarily for the conservation of musk deer and its natural habitat.

Gangotri National park is a national park in the Uttarkashi district of Uttarakhand in India. Various rare and endangered species like Bharal or blue sheep, black bear, brown bear, Himalayan manal, Himalayan snowcock, Himalayan Thar, musk deer and snow leopard are found in the park.

The Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary is a part of the Dudhwa Tiger Reserve near Mailani in Uttar Pradesh, India. It covers an area of 227 km^2 (88 sq.m.) and was founded in 1972. The tiger, chiral, hog deer, wild boars, others and many more animals find themselves a home here.

Manas National Park or Manas Wildlife Sanctuary is a national park, UNESCO Natural World Heritage site, a project tiger reserve, an elephant reserve and a biosphere reserve in Assam, India, located in the Himalayan foothills; it is contiguous with the Royal Manas National Park in Bhutan.

96. Consider the following pairs:

International Agreement/set-up		Subject
1. Alma-Ata Declaration	–	Healthcare of the people
2. Hague Convention	–	Biological and Chemical
3. Talanoa Dialogue	–	Global climate change
4. Under 2 Coalition	–	Child rights

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 4 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 2, 3 and 4 only